

1) Core Concept – “School Scanner”

What it really is

Not just a data aggregator — but an AI decision assistant for parents choosing schools or areas.

Think:

- “Rightmove + Ofsted + Reddit + ChatGPT”
 - But structured, explainable, and actionable
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2) Target Users

Primary

- Parents moving house (UK + international relocations)
- Parents choosing:
 - primary → secondary
 - state → private

Secondary

- Property buyers (schools drive house prices heavily in UK)
- Relocation consultants
- Education consultants

3) 🔍 Core User Problems (You identified these well)

Existing platforms (weaknesses)

Platforms like:

- Locrating
- Rightmove
- Ofsted

Problems:

- ❌ Data-heavy, insight-light
- ❌ No synthesis across sources
- ❌ No personalised answers
- ❌ No “real parent questions”

Real questions people ask (your edge)

These are GOLD:

- “Is this school actually good or just hyped?”
- “How religious is it in practice?”
- “Is behaviour a problem?”
- “What kind of kids go there?”

- “Do many get into Oxbridge?”
- “What are the real downsides?”

👉 These are not answered anywhere cleanly today.

4) Product Requirements

A. Core Features (MVP)

1. School Deep Dive (Agent Output)

Input:

- School name

Output:

- Structured + narrative:
 - School type (state/private, co-ed, religious depth)
 - Ofsted / ISI summary (translated, not copied)
 - Exam performance vs benchmarks
 - Oxbridge trends (where available)
 - Strengths vs weaknesses
 - Parent-style summary (“who this school suits”)

👉 This aligns perfectly with what you’ve already been asking me to do.

2. Area Scanner

Input:

- Postcode / area

Output:

- Top schools within X miles
 - Safety (crime data summary)
 - Commute to key areas (e.g. City, Canary Wharf)
 - Demographics (income proxy, density, etc.)
 - “Family friendliness score”
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3. Compare Schools

- Side-by-side comparison (huge demand)
 - Clear winner by category:
 - academics
 - pastoral care
 - outcomes
 - competitiveness
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4. “Ask Anything” Layer (Key Differentiator)

Free-form questions:

- “Is this school too strict?”
- “Is it good for shy kids?”
- “Do kids get into top universities?”

👉 This is where AI beats static platforms.

B. Data Sources (Critical for credibility)

You'll need:

- Ofsted reports
- Independent Schools Inspectorate reports
- GOV.UK performance tables
- Census / ONS data
- Crime stats (police.uk)
- Transport APIs (TfL, Google)

Optional (high value):

- Reddit scraping (parent sentiment)
 - Mumsnet (very powerful but messy)
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5) 💡 Differentiation (This is where you win)

1. Interpretation Layer (Your biggest edge)

Others give:

“Progress 8 score = 0.6”

You give:

“Above average — but not top-tier selective level”

2. “Reality vs Reputation”

Example:

- “Popular locally, but exam results are average”
- “Strict discipline — great for structure, not for creative kids”

👉 This is what parents actually want

3. Religious Depth Analysis

Not just:

- “Church of England”

But:

- “Light-touch vs deeply embedded in daily life”

Huge unmet need.

4. Oxbridge + Outcomes Proxy

Even if data is incomplete:

- Use signals:
 - A-level results
 - historical mentions
 - school type

👉 No one does this cleanly.

6) 💰 Business Model

Option 1: Freemium (Best starting point)

Free:

- Basic school summary

Paid (£5–£10 one-off or £10/month):

- Deep dives
- Comparisons
- Area reports
- Unlimited Q&A

👉 Your insight is correct:

People don't want subscriptions → consider pay-per-report (£3–£5)

Option 2: B2B (Higher value)

Sell to:

- Relocation agencies
 - Property agents
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Option 3: Lead Gen

- Partner with:
 - tutors
 - schools
 - relocation firms
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7) Market Validation (Strong signal)

You already spotted it:

- Reddit → constant repeated questions
- Facebook groups → high engagement
- WhatsApp → word-of-mouth dependency

👉 This indicates:

- High demand

- Low trust in existing tools
 - Need for interpretation
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8) Key Risks

1. Data accuracy (critical)

If wrong → trust collapses

👉 Solution:

- Cite sources
 - Show confidence levels
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2. Hallucination risk (AI)

👉 Must:

- Anchor to structured data
 - Avoid making up stats (e.g. Oxbridge numbers)
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3. Legal / reputation risk

- Schools may object to “opinions”

👉 Solution:

- Phrase as:
 - “Based on inspection reports...”
 - “Common parent feedback suggests...”
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9) MVP Build Approach (Lean)

Phase 1 (2–4 weeks)

- Prompt-based system (like what you’re already doing)
 - Manual data sourcing
 - Simple UI (even Notion / web form)
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Phase 2

- Automate:
 - Ofsted parsing
 - GOV data ingestion
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Phase 3

- Add:

- Area intelligence
 - Personalisation
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10) 🔥 Honest Take (Important)

This idea is:

✅ Strong on real user need

✅ Strong on AI advantage

✅ Easy to MVP quickly

! Hard part = trust + data quality

11) What I'd Do Next (Practical Steps)

1. Pick 10 schools parents care about
2. Create "perfect reports" (manually + AI)
3. Share in:
 - Reddit
 - Facebook groups

👉 Measure:

- Engagement
- Follow-up questions

- Willingness to pay